# Drawing the Lines

AP Human Geography · Unit 4 · Two stimuli (like Question 3) · 7 points · Student handout · GeoArcade FRQ Tutor

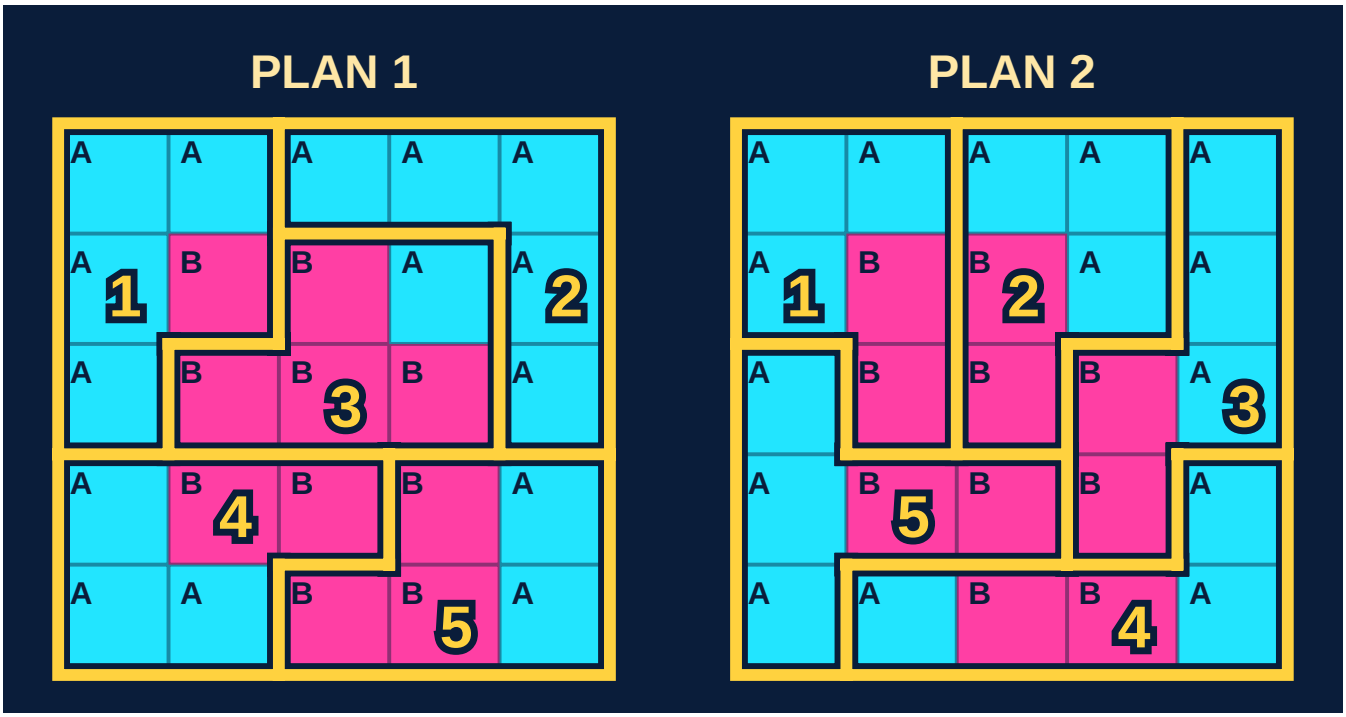
Name _____ Date _____ Period _____

**Directions:** Answer all parts of the question. Respond in complete sentences; an outline or bulleted list is not acceptable. Label each part (A, B, C...). For Describe and Explain parts, write it out with **T1-** (your reason in general words), **E2-** (the specific proof), and **A3-** (why it matters).

Westmoor, a fictional U.S. state, has 25 voting precincts with equal populations and 5 seats in the U.S. House of Representatives. After the census, mapmakers proposed two plans for grouping those precincts into 5 districts, using the same voters and votes.

**Westmoor Redistricting: Two District Plans (Stimulus 1) and Election Results (Stimulus 2)**

**Stimulus 1: Two District Plans for Westmoor**




*Fictional state created for practice. Simplified: all 25 precincts have equal populations, and a party wins a district by winning at least 3 of its 5 precincts.*

**Stimulus 2: Election Results in Westmoor Under Each Plan**

| Result | Party A | Party B |
|---|---|---|
| **Statewide vote share** | 60% | 40% |
| **Precincts won (of 25)** | 15 | 10 |
| **Districts won under Plan 1 (of 5)** | 3 | 2 |
| **Percent of seats under Plan 1** | 60% | 40% |
| **Districts won under Plan 2 (of 5)** | 5 | 0 |
| **Percent of seats under Plan 2** | 100% | 0% |

*Fictional data created for practice. Simplified: equal-population precincts, and the same statewide vote under both plans. Remember: label each part, and write Describe and Explain parts as T1- (your reason in general words), E2- (the specific proof), A3- (why it matters).*

**A. Using Stimulus 1, identify the gerrymandering technique used to draw the district boundaries in Plan 2.** IDENTIFY

**B. Using Stimulus 1, describe how the district boundaries in Plan 2 divide Party B's voters.** DESCRIBE

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**

**C. Explain why the boundaries of congressional districts in the United States are redrawn every ten years.** EXPLAIN

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**

**D.** **Using both stimuli, explain how Plan 2 produces an election result that does not match the statewide vote.** EXPLAIN

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**

**E.** **Using Stimulus 2, explain ONE effect that a districting plan like Plan 2 could have on voters or on political representation.** EXPLAIN

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**

**F.** **Explain ONE way that an independent redistricting commission OR a compactness requirement could reduce gerrymandering like the one in Plan 2.** EXPLAIN

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**

**G.** **Explain how district boundaries like those in Plan 2 could act as a centrifugal force in a country.** EXPLAIN

**T1-**

**E2-**

**A3-**